

Termux + Claude Code Remote Control

How to run Claude Code in Termux and drive it from your phone's browser or the Claude app — plus the one setting that silently breaks it, and the open bug to watch for if you wrap it in tmux.

01 WHAT THIS ACTUALLY IS

Remote Control is an official Anthropic feature (research preview, all plans). It connects claude.ai/code or the Claude mobile app to a `claude` session running on your phone in Termux. Execution and filesystem access never leave the device — the web/mobile view is just a window into the same session.

It is **not** the same thing as `--cloud`, which runs Claude Code on Anthropic's own servers instead of your machine. Remote Control keeps everything local; `--cloud` moves everything off-device. Don't confuse the two — the requirements and flags are different.

02 START IT

```
# in a real project directory – the trust dialog never saves for $HOME,  
# so starting from your home folder means re-confirming every time  
cd ~/my-project
```

```
# server mode – stays running, prints a session URL,  
# press spacebar for a QR code, supports several sessions at once  
claude remote-control
```

```
# OR: one interactive session, works from your terminal AND remotely  
claude --remote-control
```

```
# OR: turn it on inside a session that's already running
```

```
# OR, turn it on inside a session that's already running
/remote-control
```

To connect from your phone or another computer: open the printed URL, scan the QR code straight into the Claude app, or find the session by name at claude.ai/code — it shows a green dot when the Termux side is online.

03 BEFORE YOU START — FOUR THINGS THAT SILENTLY DISABLE IT

! You must be logged in with a real **claude.ai** account, not an API key. Run `claude` then `/login` if you haven't. This is the one that matters most — see the warning below.

! Start it inside a **project folder**, not your home directory — the workspace-trust prompt won't remember a home-directory session.

! Check your shell profile for `DISABLE_TELEMETRY`, `DO_NOT_TRACK`, `CLAUDE_CODE_DISABLE_NONESSENTIAL_TRAFFIC`, or `DISABLE_GROWTHBOOK`. Any one of these silently turns Remote Control off. Unset all four if present.

! If you've set `ANTHROPIC_BASE_URL` to point at a proxy or gateway instead of Anthropic directly, Remote Control won't work — unset it, or use a different terminal for this.

04 THE CONFLICT THAT WILL BITE YOU

READ THIS BEFORE TROUBLESHOOTING ANYTHING ELSE

If you've ever fixed Termux asking you to log in over and over by switching to `export ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=...` — **that workaround makes Remote Control impossible**. Remote Control checks for a real OAuth login and refuses outright if it finds an API key instead, with no override.

There's no way to have both "stopped re-auth loop via API key" and "Remote Control working" at the same time. You need OAuth to actually hold on this device, not routed around.

05 KEEPING IT ALIVE WHEN YOU BACKGROUND TERMUX

The claude process has to keep running — close Termux (not just switch apps) and the session ends. To make it survive backgrounding, run it inside tmux:

```
tmux new -s remote
claude remote-control
# Ctrl-B, then D – detaches. Session + Remote Control connection both survive

# later, to check on it or reattach locally:
tmux attach -t remote
```

BUT CHECK THIS FIRST

There's an open, unresolved upstream bug reporting **repeated re-auth prompts specifically inside tmux**, even with valid stored credentials ([anthropics/claude-code #9903](#)). Test plain `claude remote-control` outside tmux first. If that stays logged in cleanly, the bug is tmux-specific on your setup and wrapping it will reintroduce the loop you're trying to avoid.

06 TROUBLESHOOTING FLOW

If you're stuck in a re-auth loop, work through this in order rather than guessing at fixes:

1 · Check what's actually stored

`ls -la ~/.claude/` right after logging in. Note whether it's there.

↓

2 · Close Termux the way you normally do, reopen, check again

`ls -la ~/.claude/` a second time.

↓ file gone?

Yes, it's gone

Something is deleting it on close — check for a Termux:Boot script, a stray `rm` in `.bashrc/.profile`, or a proot/container setup that doesn't persist `$HOME`.

No, still there

The file persists but you're still asked to log in — the bug is elsewhere (wrong `$HOME` being read, a different user context, or the token itself expiring)

server-side). Not a wake-lock or battery-optimization issue either way — those only affect process survival, not stored credentials.

07 QUICK REFERENCE

COMMAND	DOES
<code>claude remote-control</code>	Server mode. Stays open, prints URL + QR, supports multiple sessions.
<code>claude --remote-control</code>	One interactive session, usable locally and remotely at once.
<code>/remote-control</code>	Turn it on inside a session already running.
<code>/login</code>	The only auth method Remote Control accepts.
<code>tmux new -s remote</code>	Wrap it so it survives backgrounding — check §05's warning first.

08 KILLED GUESSES – DON'T RETRY THESE

- ✗ "Use an API key to dodge re-auth, then start Remote Control anyway." Contradictory by design — confirmed in the official docs, not a bug. An API key blocks Remote Control unconditionally.
- ✗ "A wake-lock fixes the re-auth loop." Wake-lock only prevents CPU sleep during an active run — unrelated to whether credentials persist between launches.
- ✗ "Wrapping it in tmux is automatically safer." Not proven — there's an open bug specifically about tmux re-auth. Test without it first.

– SOURCES

- [Claude Code Remote Control — official docs](#)
- [Claude Code on the web — official docs \(--cloud vs --teleport\)](#)
- [anthropics/claude-code #9903 — persistent re-auth in tmux, open](#)

Also filed in Horizons-UI: `skills/termux-mobile-dev/SKILL.md`